VOL. 67 EDITION 4 · APRIL 2024

LVNA Villager

WELCOME TO THE NEWSLETTER OF THE LAKEWOOD VILLAGE NEIGHBORHOOD ASSOCIATION



LVNA General Meeting and Board Elections - April 10

Our next quarterly neighborhood association meeting is Wednesday, April 10, 2024 from 7:00-8:00pm at the Lakewood Park Building. The first part of the meeting will be the nomination and election of the LVNA board for the 2024-2025 year. The second part of the meeting will be a "meet your neighbor" discussion.

There are five board positions: President, 1st Vice President, 2nd Vice President, Treasurer, and Secretary. The current board's positions end in April and a new board will begin. The board meets once per month to discuss ongoing activities, in addition to holding quarterly neighborhood general meetings and a few seasonal events each year. The level of commitment is up to each individual - these are all volunteer roles. It is a one-year term (April 2024 - March 2025). The only requirements are that you are 18+ years old, live in the neighborhood, and are able to serve the full 12 month term. For more information, attend the meeting or please email board@lvnasv.org

Annual Dumpster Day at Risk - VOLUNTEERS NEEDED



We are at risk of having to cancel our annual Dumpster Day event due to lack of volunteers. We need 15 volunteers, and we only have 8 people signed up. Dumpster Day will be either Saturday, July 13 or Saturday, July 20, from 8:00am-2:00pm. Join the LVNA group on Nextdoor or check the upcoming May Villager for the final date.

Dumpster Day has been an annual tradition for many years. Open to Lakewood and Fairwood residents, it allows us a chance to dispose of RESIDENTIAL garbage for free. Last year, we hosted 20 dumpsters (including 2 for tree trimmings and 2 for mattresses/carpeting) across the neighborhood. We collected 98.85 tons of garbage. Goodwill donates 15 cents to LVNA for every pound of items donated during the event, and they take adult and children's clothing, shoes, accessories, toys, books, small appliances, and more. Last year, Goodwill gave LVNA a check for $1001 from all the donations. This money went to support a variety of LVNA programs.

We need volunteers on both the Lakewood and Fairwood sides to do the following:

- Host dumpsters at their house and monitor the dumpsters on Dumpster Day
- Monitor the dumpster behind the Shell Gas Station (this dumpster is for mattresses and carpets)
- Help monitor the Goodwill truck at Fairwood Elementary (this is for Goodwill donations and electronics recycling)
- Help making lunch and delivering it to dumpster monitors.

Please volunteer so that we can continue this wonderful event. Email treasurer@lvnasv.org or call/text Linh at (650) 405-1560 to volunteer. We need a final count of volunteers by May 15, so sign up before then!

Welcome to the Expanded Online April Villager!

We couldn't fit everything in a two page printout, so this April online version contains additional articles on pages 4-6. Topics include the recent vote by Fremont Union High School District (FUHSD) to replace the 6 old artificial turf fields with more artificial turf; planned improvements for Fairwood and Lakewood; and additional Earth Day events.



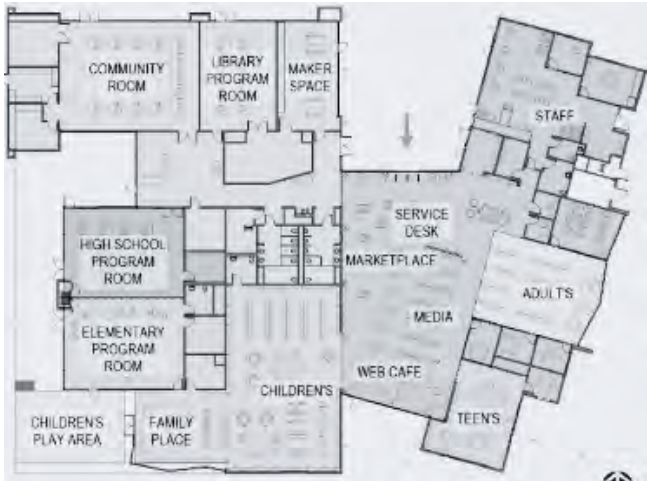
Lakewood Library Update

Monday, March 4 was a special joint City meeting between the Parks and Recreation Commission and the Board of Library Trustees to provide an update on the Lakewood Library project. The full recording can be found here (https://tinyurl.com/LakewoodLibraryMar4; the Lakewood Library update starts at timestamp 1:01:15) and the presentation slides here (https://tinyurl.com/LakewoodLibrarySlides).

In 2023, the design was completed and DSA paperwork was submitted to the state for approval. Bids for construction opened at the end of March, and construction will start this summer. The library is expected to open by the end of 2025. The library will also include several pieces of public art - that selection process is underway.

The library will include:

- After-hours holds pickup/checkout
- Makerspace
- Tech skills and creation lab (for people to develop podcasts or audio animation)
- Outdoor, enclosed children's space
- Multiple event/meeting spaces, including a community room, a library program room, and program rooms for Sunnyvale School District (SSD) and Fremont Union High School District (FUHSD)



FUHSD Trustee Election Update

It has been just over one year since the Fremont Union High School District (FUHSD) voted unanimously to move from at-large to by-trustee elections. In March, the the Committee for Trustee Area Districting (CTAD) selected 3 potential district maps and drafted proposed election sequence(s) for each map. District maps will divide the district into five areas. Per federal law, each area must have nearly equal populations (less than 10% total variance). District maps are based on total population (instead of voting population or FUHSD families) because the school district serves all families who live in the area, not just those who are of voting age or already have students attending a FUHSD school.

The three maps are online here: https://tinyurl.com/MapScenario5, https://tinyurl.com/MapScenario6, and https://tinyurl.com/MapScenario7.
This will be the first time that there will be a trustee who lives in North Sunnyvale on the FUHSD board, so it's important that our voices are heard regarding which map we prefer. Please review the maps and share your feedback (including simply stating which map(s) you like) supports the move to by-trustee area elections and helps ensure equal representation on the FUHSD board. Email input can be sent to trusteeareas@fuhsd.org The final map hearing will be at the April 24 FUHSD board meeting.

For more information, visit https://www.fuhsd.org/newsroom/trustee-areas, view the CTAD Informational Presentation at https://tinyurl.com/CTADPresentation, or view the March 20 CTAD presentation to the FUHSD board at https://tinyurl.com/CTADMarch20



Sidewalk Improvements

Did you notice all the work to improve the sidewalks in Lakewood last month? You weren't alone! The City's "Concreate Sidewalk, Curb, Gutter, and Driveway Approaches 2023" project focused on repairing sidewalks, curbs, gutters, and driveways across the City. Within our neighborhood, improvements were made on the following streets: Colton Ave, Garner Dr, Greenlake Dr, Hamlin Ct, Manzano Wy, Oak Creek Wy, Fairwood Ave, Pecos Wy, Sandia Av, Havenwood Av, Socorro Av, Stoneylake Ct, Tucson Av, Twinlake Dr, Velvetlake Dr, and Hiddenlake Dr. Work was also done in SNAIL under the "Sunnyvale SNAIL Neighborhood Improvements." That project installed 18 new ADA compliant curb ramps.

Flashing beacons (the "HAWK" system) are going to be installed at the intersection of San Miguel Ave and Duane Ave. This is a critical intersection for students who walk to San Miguel Elementary School. Additional updates on signs and striping occurred on Borregas Ave (between Maude Ave and Ahwanee Ave).

A huge thank you to our City Council for prioritizing these improvements in North Sunnyvale - and a huge thank you for the Department of Public Works for making these improvements!



Workers from the City's Department of Public Works replace sidewalks in our neighborhood.



A completed, brand new sidewalk on the Fairwood side of the neighborhood.



Sunnyvale Schools to Get New Playground Surface Materials

At its March 14 board meeting, the Sunnyvale School District began the process of approving contracts for site improvements at its schools over the summer (Agenda Items 10.B and 10.C). The site improvements include:

- Installing digital marquee signs (San Miguel, Lakewood, Cumberland, and Columbia)
- Replacing the rubber play matting understand existing play structures with artificial turf (Bishop, Cumberland, Columbia, Fairwood, Lakewood, San Miguel, and Vargas)
- Applying standard and colored asphalt slurry on top of the blacktop (Columbia, San Miguel, and Vargas)
- Adding a shade structure (San Miguel)

The projects are divided into two contracts: (1) Agenda Item 10.B for San Miguel, Lakewood, Cumberland, and Columbia, which will require electrical work to install the digital marquee signs; and (2) Agenda Item 10.C was for Bishop, Fairwood, and Vargas, which already have digital marquee signs and do not require electrical work.

Several community members spoke out in opposition to the selection of artificial turf (AT) as the new playground surface material. Their primary objections to AT were its contribution to climate change; its use of PFAS chemicals, which have been linked to several negative health effects; and artificial turf's contribution to microplastics and environmental pollution. The community members recommended engineered wood fiber (EWF) instead of AT. EWF recommended by multiple organizations - Safe Healthy Playing Fields (SHPFI) and TURI (Toxic Use Reduction Institute), among others - as a safe, ADA-compliant material for playground surface materials. Representatives from SHPFI and the Plastic Prevention Pollution Committee of the Loma Prieta Chapter of the Sierra Club also called in to speak against AT and in favor of EWF.

The board discussion focused mostly on safety, ADA-compliance (particularly surfaces that are wheelchair-accessible), the need for cooler outside areas at our schools, and the role that plastics should play in our lives. Despite evidence presented by community members to support using EWF instead of AT, the board still viewed AT as the only ADA-compliant playground surface material. The discussion about reducing the number of hot surfaces at school properties covered many important details, but it did not include mention of State Bill 499, which stalled last year and would have required schools to "remove harmful surfaces such as asphalt, concrete, rubber, and synthetic turf and replace them with cooler surfaces."

The board voted to follow the staff recommendation. For Item 10.B (which includes Lakewood), all bids were rejected. The project will be rebid (the two contractors with the lowest bids did not go through the pre-qualification process, so the rebid gives them time to get pre-qualified). For Item 10.C (which includes Fairwood), the contracts were approved by a 4-1 vote (board member Eileen Le voted in opposition, due to the selection of AT as the playground surface material).

Item 10.B will be presented again at a future board meeting (likely April 4) for approval. Construction for all schools is planned for this summer.



Update on Artifical Turf at Fremont and Homestead High Schools

On Tuesday, February 27, the FUHSD board voted unanimously to replace six artificial turf (AT) fields (three at Fremont High School (FHS) and three at Homestead High School (HHS)) with more artificial turf fields. This was done in spite of several letters from community members highlighting the negative environmental, health, and safety impacts of AT. Several organizations - including Santa Clara County Medical Association, Sierra Club's Loma Prieta chapter, Safe Healthy Playing Fields (SHPFI), Sustainable Silicon Valley, and PEER (Public Employees for Environmental Responsibility) - wrote letters in support of natural grass. Supervisor Otto Lee wrote a letter in favor of natural grass, and Mothers Out Front wrote a letter in favor of natural grass, which was co-signed by Silicon Valley Youth Climate Action, 350 Silicon Valley, Climate Action California, and Elders Climate Action.

The agenda was structured such that discussion on artificial turf (Agenda Item 14.1) started at 10:20pm. Due to the late hour, the board limited public comments to one minute each and cut off public comments before everyone had spoken.

The presentation by district staff compared old, traditional natural grass to modern AT. There was no mention of the third option - modern, organically managed natural grass fields. The presentation claimed that maintenance for AT fields is less than for natural grass fields, despite clear evidence from SHPFI and others that the maintenance of AT is comparable to the maintenance of natural grass fields. The presentation also highlighted concerns that natural grass uses fertilizers and herbicides, which contribute to water pollution. The presentation did not address the fact that AT fields are a substantial source of water pollution, both as a source of microplastic contamination and as a source of PFAS chemical contamination.

Construction on the fields is planned to start the day after graduation, which meant that the district waited until the last minute to approve the contract. The fields are used by multiple sports teams during the school year, which means the fields must stand up to heavy use. There was no information presented on whether or not modern, organically managed natural grass fields are compatible with heavy use, and performing the due diligence of contacting natural grass experts for accurate information would have delayed the project schedule. Because the replacement of the fields at FHS and HHS is already at least two years overdue, further delays could have required field closure due to safety concerns.

Bond money will finance the construction. The cost of the total project (which will replace a total of 12 AT fields with more AT) is approximately $23,000,000. No financial information regarding the costs for just the FHS and HHS fields was presented in Tuesday's board meeting. The new AT fields only last about 10-12 years, so they will need to be replaced again in approximately 2035 with an expected cost of $20-$30 million dollars in future bond money.

There are six more fields in FUHSD that will need replacing (two each for Cupertino High, Lynbrook High, and Monta Vista High). The demand from the community is that, prior to determining the material used for these six fields, the board must require an updated presentation comparing modern, organically managed natural grass options with modern AT.



Earth Day Celebrations

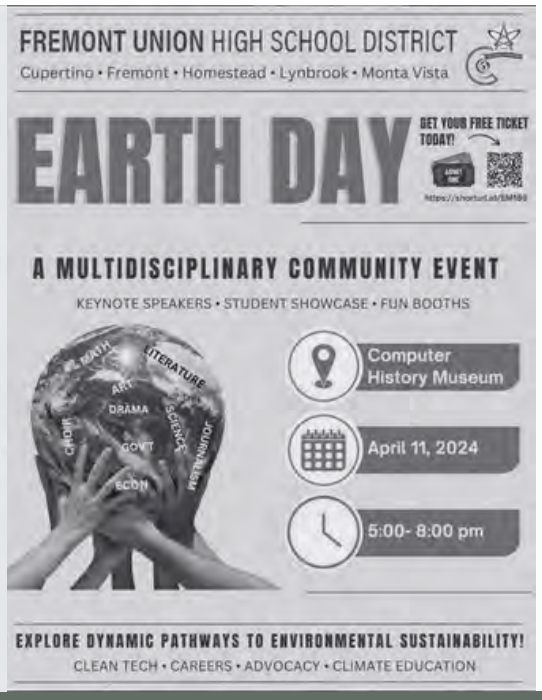
This year, Earth Day is Monday, April 22. The theme is “Planet vs Plastics.” Here are some ways to celebrate.

1. The City of Sunnyvale is hosting an Earth Day Festival on April 20. The event highlights the Grand Opening of the new Civic Center campus, and will include family-friendly activities and information from local organizations. Activities include sustainable arts and crafts for kids, a cooking demonstration by Anne-Marie Bonneau, the Zero-Waste Chef, live entertainment, a session by Master Composters on how to start a home compost, and more. Details are on the City’s webpage here: https://tinyurl.com/SunnyvaleEarthDay



2. The FUHSD Climate Collective is celebrating Earth Day at the Computer History Museum on April 11. Tickets are required and free. More information is available here: fuhsdclimatecollec.wixsite.com/fuhsd-climate-collec/earth-day-event







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Advertise in the Villager!!

Want to advertise in the Villager? Our printed newsletter goes to over 1600 homes in our neighborhood, and our electronic newsletter is sent out each month. It's a great, affordable way to publicize your business while support your neighborhood association. Please email vp1@lvnasv.org if you are interested in advertising. Prices are shown in the table.

Ad Size	For 1 printed issue	For 6 consecutive printed issues	For 12 consecutive printed issues
Business card	$40	$200	$380
Quarter page	$80	$400	$775
Half page	$160	$800	$1525
Full page	$320	$1600	$3100

Important Numbers

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911

Abandoned Vehicles
(408) 730-7150

Shopping Carts & Graffiti
(408) 730-7680

Animal Control
(408) 730-7178

Parks & Maintenance
(408) 730-7506

Public Safety - Info
(408) 730-7100

Public Safety - Non-Emergency
(408) 730-7180

Street Lights/Sidewalks
(408) 730-7415

Street Trees/Parks
(408) 730-7505

Recap of Jan 10 General Meeting (Cont.)

Wondering about the FoodCycle program? In 2021, 65% of Sunnyvale residents participated in the program, which diverts 5000 tons of food per year from the landfill. FoodCycle is going to be even more important now. Recent state law SB1383 requires communities to reduce the amount of organics going into the landfill by 75% by 2025. All of the food that goes into the FoodCycle bin is used to generate electricity.

Some final food for thought:

- There's a reason the order is "reduce, reuse, recycle." Want to reduce your environmental footprint? First, reduce how much you buy. Second, reuse what you buy. And only then should you recycle it.
- Use the "Sunnyvale Recycles Right" app on your phone or the "How to Get Rid of Anything" feature on the City's website to check if something is recyclable.
- Remember, "when in doubt, throw it out - and remember the Nice Nine!", a digital copy is here: http://tinyurl.com/SunnyvaleRecycling

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